CULTURAL AND SOCIAL GEOGRAPHY OF INDIA

BUILDING BLOCKS OF A → REGION TYPES COMPARED → HEARTH TO IDENTITY SEQUENCE → DISTRIBUTION AND DENSITY FIREWALL → CONTROLS ON POPULATION DISTRIBUTION → GANGA BASIN CONVERGENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 BUILDING BLOCKS OF A CULTURAL REGION

STAGE 00

BUILDING BLOCKS OF A CULTURAL REGION · COMMUNICATION AND LITERARY CORE WITH A HEARTH AND A · SACRED SITES, RITUAL CALENDARS, GROUP IDENTITY AND LANDSCAPES · TRIBE AND ETHNICITY · HISTORICAL COMMUNITIES ASSOCIATED WITH A HABITAT · LIVELIHOOD AND MIGRATION · THE CULTURAL LANDSCAPE OF WORK: DIFFUSION AND MIXING · STATE POLICY

LANGUAGE → communication and literary core with a hearth and a spread

RELIGION → sacred sites, ritual calendars, group identity and landscapes → **TRIBE AND ETHNICITY → historical communities associated with a habitat** → **LIVELIHOOD AND MIGRATION → the cultural landscape of work: diffusion and mixing**

CORE CLAIM

- LANGUAGE → communication and literary core with a hearth and a spread
- RELIGION → sacred sites, ritual calendars, group identity and landscapes
- TRIBE AND ETHNICITY → historical communities associated with a habitat

MECHANISM

- LIVELIHOOD AND MIGRATION → the cultural landscape of work: diffusion and mixing
- STATE POLICY → linguistic states, schedules, autonomy arrangements and reservation
- MUST REMEMBER: Cultural and social geography examines language, religion, caste, tribe, ethnicity, gender, livelihood, landscape, place identity and

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- cultural area, hearth, route, frontier, sacred landscape and vernacular region are analytical tools rather than fixed natural containers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Cultural and social geography examines language, religion, caste, tribe, ethnicity, gender, livelihood, landscape, place identity and diffusion across India's plural regions; cultural area, hearth, route, frontier, sacred landscape and vernacular region are analytical tools rather than fixed natural containers.

01 REGION TYPES COMPARED

STAGE 01

REGION TYPES COMPARED · A DOMINANT SHARED TRAIT SUCH AS LANGUAGE OR RELIGION · INTERACTION THROUGH PILGRIMAGE, MARKET OR MEDIA TIES THE AREA · A NAMED, IMAGINED REGION SUCH AS THE HINDI BELT · FUNCTIONAL CIRCUITS ROUTINELY CUT ACROSS FORMAL BOUNDARIES · EXAM USE · NAME THE TYPE FIRST, THEN ARGUE ABOUT THE BOUNDARY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FORMAL → a dominant shared trait such as language or religion defines the area	VERNACULAR → a named, imagined region such as the Hindi belt, Deccan or North-East	EXAM USE → name the type first, then argue about the boundary
FUNCTIONAL → interaction through pilgrimage, market or media ties the area together	OVERLAP → functional circuits routinely cut across formal boundaries	FORMAL → a dominant shared trait such as language or religion defines the area

CORE CLAIM

- FORMAL → a dominant shared trait such as language or religion defines the area
- FUNCTIONAL → interaction through pilgrimage, market or media ties the area together

MECHANISM

- VERNACULAR → a named, imagined region such as the Hindi belt, Deccan or North-East
- OVERLAP → functional circuits routinely cut across formal boundaries

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EXAM USE → name the type first, then argue about the boundary
- FORMAL → a dominant shared trait such as language or religion defines the area

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM USE → name the type first, then argue about the boundary.

02 HEARTH TO IDENTITY SEQUENCE

STAGE 02

HEARTH TO IDENTITY SEQUENCE · CULTURAL HEARTH · THE SOURCE AREA WHERE THE TRAIT ORIGINATES · SPREAD ALONG ROUTES, RIVERS, MARKETS AND MIGRATION CORRIDORS · OVERLAP ZONE · TWO TRADITIONS COEXIST AND INTERACT IN THE SAME SPACE · MIXED BORDERLAND · BILINGUAL BELTS, SYNCRETIC PRACTICE AND SHARED CALENDARS

CULTURAL HEARTH → the source area where the trait originates → **DIFFUSION → spread along routes, rivers, markets and migration corridors** → **OVERLAP ZONE → two traditions coexist and interact in the same space** → **MIXED BORDERLAND → bilingual belts, syncretic practice and shared calendars** → **NEW REGIONAL IDENTITY → the margin produces its own recognised character**

CORE CLAIM

- CULTURAL HEARTH → the source area where the trait originates
- DIFFUSION → spread along routes, rivers, markets and migration corridors

MECHANISM

- OVERLAP ZONE → two traditions coexist and interact in the same space
- MIXED BORDERLAND → bilingual belts, syncretic practice and shared calendars

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NEW REGIONAL IDENTITY → the margin produces its own recognised character
- CULTURAL HEARTH → the source area where the trait originates

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NEW REGIONAL IDENTITY → the margin produces its own recognised character.

03 DISTRIBUTION AND DENSITY FIREWALL

STAGE 03

DISTRIBUTION AND DENSITY FIREWALL · THE SPATIAL ARRANGEMENT OF PEOPLE; ANSWERS THE WHERE QUESTION · A RATIO OF PEOPLE TO AREA; ANSWERS THE HOW · TOTAL POPULATION OVER TOTAL AREA; MISLEADS WHERE LAND IS · POPULATION OVER CULTIVABLE AREA; EXPOSES HIDDEN LAND PRESSURE · FARMING POPULATION OVER CULTIVABLE AREA; ISOLATES AGRARIAN PRESSURE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DISTRIBUTION → the spatial arrangement of people; answers the where question	ARITHMETIC → total population over total area; misleads where land is uninhabitable	AGRICULTURAL → farming population over cultivable area; isolates agrarian pressure
DENSITY → a ratio of people to area; answers the how concentrated question	PHYSIOLOGICAL → population over cultivable area; exposes hidden land pressure	DISTRIBUTION → the spatial arrangement of people; answers the where question

CORE CLAIM

- DISTRIBUTION → the spatial arrangement of people; answers the where question
- DENSITY → a ratio of people to area; answers the how concentrated question

MECHANISM

- ARITHMETIC → total population over total area; misleads where land is uninhabitable
- PHYSIOLOGICAL → population over cultivable area; exposes hidden land pressure

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AGRICULTURAL → farming population over cultivable area; isolates agrarian pressure
- DISTRIBUTION → the spatial arrangement of people; answers the where question

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AGRICULTURAL → farming population over cultivable area; isolates agrarian pressure.

04 CONTROLS ON POPULATION DISTRIBUTION

STAGE 04

CONTROLS ON POPULATION DISTRIBUTION · RELIEF AND SOIL · LEVEL LAND AND DEEP RENEWABLE ALLUVIUM PERMIT INTENSIVE SETTLEMENT · RAINFALL, PERENNIAL RIVERS AND SHALLOW GROUNDWATER SET CROPPING INTENSITY · GROWING-SEASON LENGTH AND RELIABILITY DETER OR PERMIT OCCUPATION · VALLEYS CARRYING MILLENNIA OF SETTLEMENT, URBANISM AND STATE FORMATION · ECONOMY AND CONNECTIVITY · INDUSTRY, PORTS, IRRIGATED COMMANDS, RAIL AND CANAL NETWORKS

RELIEF AND SOIL → level land and deep renewable alluvium permit intensive settlement

WATER → rainfall, perennial rivers and shallow groundwater set cropping intensity → **CLIMATE → growing-season length and reliability deter or permit occupation** → **HISTORY → valleys carrying millennia of settlement, urbanism and state formation**

CORE CLAIM

- RELIEF AND SOIL → level land and deep renewable alluvium permit intensive settlement
- WATER → rainfall, perennial rivers and shallow groundwater set cropping intensity

MECHANISM

- CLIMATE → growing-season length and reliability deter or permit occupation
- HISTORY → valleys carrying millennia of settlement, urbanism and state formation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ECONOMY AND CONNECTIVITY → industry, ports, irrigated commands, rail and canal networks
- RELIEF AND SOIL → level land and deep renewable alluvium permit intensive settlement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ECONOMY AND CONNECTIVITY → industry, ports, irrigated commands, rail and canal networks.

05 GANGA BASIN CONVERGENCE

STAGE 05

GANGA BASIN CONVERGENCE · LEVEL EXTENSIVE ALLUVIAL PLAIN · ALMOST THE WHOLE SURFACE IS CULTIVABLE AND TRAVERSABLE · DEEP RENEWABLE ALLUVIUM · KHADAR TRACTS ARE RENEWED BY ANNUAL DEPOSITION · PERENNIAL SNOW-FED RIVERS · ASSURED WATER UNLIKE SEASONAL PENINSULAR RIVERS · SHALLOW PRODUCTIVE AQUIFERS

LEVEL EXTENSIVE ALLUVIAL PLAIN → almost the whole surface is cultivable and traversable → **DEEP RENEWABLE ALLUVIUM → khadar tracts are renewed by annual deposition** → **PERENNIAL SNOW-FED RIVERS → assured water unlike seasonal peninsular rivers** → **SHALLOW PRODUCTIVE AQUIFERS → tube-well irrigation permits multiple cropping** → **HISTORY AND TRANSPORT → inherited settlement plus dense networks on level ground**

CORE CLAIM

- LEVEL EXTENSIVE ALLUVIAL PLAIN → almost the whole surface is cultivable and traversable
- DEEP RENEWABLE ALLUVIUM → khadar tracts are renewed by annual deposition

MECHANISM

- PERENNIAL SNOW-FED RIVERS → assured water unlike seasonal peninsular rivers
- SHALLOW PRODUCTIVE AQUIFERS → tube-well irrigation permits multiple cropping

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- HISTORY AND TRANSPORT → inherited settlement plus dense networks on level ground
- LEVEL EXTENSIVE ALLUVIAL PLAIN → almost the whole surface is cultivable and traversable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HISTORY AND TRANSPORT → inherited settlement plus dense networks on level ground.

06 BASIN INTERNAL VARIATION

STAGE 06

BASIN INTERNAL VARIATION · WEST TO EAST · DENSITY RISES FROM THE DRIER WEST TOWARD THE WETTER · NORTHERN FRINGE · TARAI CONSTRAINTS DIFFER SHARPLY FROM THE CENTRAL PLAIN · LOWER AND DELTAIC BASIN · VERY HIGH RURAL DENSITY WITH FLOOD AND EROSION EXPOSURE · URBAN-INDUSTRIAL NODES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
WEST TO EAST → density rises from the drier west toward the wetter middle and lower basin	LOWER AND DELTAIC BASIN → very high rural density with flood and erosion exposure	RULE → never write the basin as an internally uniform region
NORTHERN FRINGE → tarai constraints differ sharply from the central plain	URBAN-INDUSTRIAL NODES → density peaks that agriculture does not explain	WEST TO EAST → density rises from the drier west toward the wetter middle and lower basin

CORE CLAIM

- WEST TO EAST → density rises from the drier west toward the wetter middle and lower basin
- NORTHERN FRINGE → tarai constraints differ sharply from the central plain

MECHANISM

- LOWER AND DELTAIC BASIN → very high rural density with flood and erosion exposure
- URBAN-INDUSTRIAL NODES → density peaks that agriculture does not explain

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RULE → never write the basin as an internally uniform region
- WEST TO EAST → density rises from the drier west toward the wetter middle and lower basin

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never write the basin as an internally uniform region.

07 DENSITY CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

STAGE 07

DENSITY CONSEQUENCE CHAIN · HIGH PHYSIOLOGICAL DENSITY · HOLDINGS BECOME SMALL AND CONTINUE FRAGMENTING · SMALL HOLDINGS · INVESTABLE SURPLUS AND MECHANISATION CAPACITY FALL · LAND PRESSURE · GROUNDWATER OVER-ABSTRACTION AND OUT-MIGRATION FOLLOW · FLOODPLAIN SETTLEMENT

HIGH PHYSIOLOGICAL DENSITY → holdings become small and continue fragmenting → **SMALL HOLDINGS → investable surplus and mechanisation capacity fall** → **LAND PRESSURE → groundwater over-abstraction and out-migration follow** → **FLOODPLAIN SETTLEMENT → exposure rises because the active surface is occupied** → **NATIONAL LINK → the same fertility makes the region critical to foodgrain supply**

CORE CLAIM

- HIGH PHYSIOLOGICAL DENSITY → holdings become small and continue fragmenting
- SMALL HOLDINGS → investable surplus and mechanisation capacity fall

MECHANISM

- LAND PRESSURE → groundwater over-abstraction and out-migration follow
- FLOODPLAIN SETTLEMENT → exposure rises because the active surface is occupied

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NATIONAL LINK → the same fertility makes the region critical to foodgrain supply
- HIGH PHYSIOLOGICAL DENSITY → holdings become small and continue fragmenting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NATIONAL LINK → the same fertility makes the region critical to foodgrain supply.

08 MICRO-RELIEF BELT SEQUENCE

STAGE 08

MICRO-RELIEF BELT SEQUENCE · COARSE GRAVEL AND BOULDER WASH WHERE STREAMS DISAPPEAR UNDERGROUND · MARSHY BELT WHERE THOSE STREAMS RE-EMERGE; PRODUCTIVE ONCE DRAINED · OLDER ALLUVIAL UPLAND ABOVE THE FLOOD LIMIT, OFTEN WITH · NEWER ALLUVIUM OF THE ACTIVE FLOODPLAIN, MOST FERTILE AND · ACTIVE CHANNEL BELT · LEVEES, BARS, OX-BOW LAKES AND CHAR OR DIARA LANDS

BHABAR → coarse gravel and boulder wash where streams disappear underground → **TERAI → marshy belt where those streams re-emerge; productive once drained** → **BHANGAR → older alluvial upland above the flood limit, often with kankar nodules** → **KHADAR → newer alluvium of the active floodplain, most fertile and most flood-exposed** → **ACTIVE CHANNEL BELT → levees, bars, ox-bow lakes and char or diara lands**

CORE CLAIM

- BHABAR → coarse gravel and boulder wash where streams disappear underground
- TERAI → marshy belt where those streams re-emerge; productive once drained

MECHANISM

- BHANGAR → older alluvial upland above the flood limit, often with kankar nodules
- KHADAR → newer alluvium of the active floodplain, most fertile and most flood-exposed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ACTIVE CHANNEL BELT → levees, bars, ox-bow lakes and char or diara lands
- BHABAR → coarse gravel and boulder wash where streams disappear underground

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ACTIVE CHANNEL BELT → levees, bars, ox-bow lakes and char or diara lands.

09 TWO GRADIENTS AND FIVE SUB-REGIONS

STAGE 09

TWO GRADIENTS AND FIVE SUB-REGIONS · GRADIENT ONE · RAINFALL RISES FROM THE NORTH-WEST TOWARD THE HUMID EAST · GRADIENT TWO · THE MICRO-RELIEF TRANSECT REPEATS AWAY FROM THE MOUNTAIN FRONT · WESTERN AND CENTRAL PLAIN · IRRIGATED CEREALS WITH DRAWDOWN; DENSE FRAGMENTED HOLDINGS · EASTERN PLAIN

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GRADIENT ONE → rainfall rises from the north-west toward the humid east	EASTERN PLAIN → water-rich yet productivity-constrained by gradient and drainage	language family differs from script and official status, caste distribution from caste determinism, cultural region from state boundary,
GRADIENT TWO → the micro-relief transect repeats away from the mountain front	BRAHMAPUTRA AND DELTA → braided erosion insecurity; tidal salinity and cyclone exposure	
WESTERN AND CENTRAL PLAIN → irrigated cereals with drawdown; dense fragmented holdings	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Scheduled Tribe, tribe, indigenous and ethnic group are not automatic synonyms	

CORE CLAIM

- GRADIENT ONE → rainfall rises from the north-west toward the humid east
- GRADIENT TWO → the micro-relief transect repeats away from the mountain front
- WESTERN AND CENTRAL PLAIN → irrigated cereals with drawdown; dense fragmented holdings

MECHANISM

- EASTERN PLAIN → water-rich yet productivity-constrained by gradient and drainage
- BRAHMAPUTRA AND DELTA → braided erosion insecurity; tidal salinity and cyclone exposure
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Scheduled Tribe, tribe, indigenous and ethnic group are not automatic synonyms

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- language family differs from script and official status, caste distribution from caste determinism, cultural region from state boundary,

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Scheduled Tribe, tribe, indigenous and ethnic group are not automatic synonyms; language family differs from script and official status, caste distribution from caste determinism, cultural region from state boundary, and diversity from either frictionless harmony or permanent conflict.

10 CULTURAL MARKER GEOGRAPHIES

STAGE 10

CULTURAL MARKER GEOGRAPHIES · REGIONAL CORES, TRANSITION ZONES AND RELIEF-SUSTAINED MINORITY POCKETS · CONCENTRATIONS PLUS PILGRIMAGE CIRCUITS FORMING FUNCTIONAL INTERACTION REGIONS · FORESTED HILL, PLATEAU AND NORTH-EASTERN ASSOCIATION FROM HISTORICAL ISOLATION · AGRARIAN STRUCTURES AND URBAN OCCUPATIONAL CLUSTERING LINK TO ECONOMY · CORRIDOR COMMUNITIES IN DESTINATION CITIES REDISTRIBUTE CULTURE CONTINUOUSLY · EVIDENCE LIMIT · INDO-ARYAN/DRAVIDIAN/AUSTROASIATIC/TIBETO-BURMAN LANGUAGE ZONES, TRIBAL CENTRAL BELT AND NORTHEAST, HIMALAYAN

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LANGUAGE → regional cores, transition zones and relief-sustained minority pockets	LIVELIHOOD → agrarian structures and urban occupational clustering link to economy	Census 2011 remains the completed census baseline while identities are dynamic and multi-scalar.
RELIGION → concentrations plus pilgrimage circuits forming functional interaction regions	MIGRATION → corridor communities in destination cities redistribute culture continuously	
TRIBE → forested hill, plateau and north-eastern association from historical isolation	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Indo-Aryan/Dravidian/Austroasiatic/Tibeto-Burman language zones, tribal central belt and Northeast, Himalayan and coastal livelihoods, pilgrimage networks, pastoral routes,	

CORE CLAIM

- LANGUAGE → regional cores, transition zones and relief-sustained minority pockets
- RELIGION → concentrations plus pilgrimage circuits forming functional interaction regions
- TRIBE → forested hill, plateau and north-eastern association from historical isolation

MECHANISM

- LIVELIHOOD → agrarian structures and urban occupational clustering link to economy
- MIGRATION → corridor communities in destination cities redistribute culture continuously
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Indo-Aryan/Dravidian/Austroasiatic/Tibeto-Burman language zones, tribal central belt and Northeast, Himalayan and coastal livelihoods, pilgrimage networks, pastoral routes,

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Census 2011 remains the completed census baseline while identities are dynamic and multi-scalar.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Indo-Aryan/Dravidian/Austroasiatic/Tibeto-Burman language zones, tribal central belt and Northeast, Himalayan and coastal livelihoods, pilgrimage networks, pastoral routes, borderlands and metropolitan mosaics require named maps; Census 2011 remains the completed census baseline while identities are dynamic and multi-scalar.

11 DATA DISCIPLINE AND THE POLICY-MAPPING ANCHOR

STAGE 11

DATA DISCIPLINE AND THE POLICY-MAPPING ANCHOR · CENSUS RULE · THE LAST COMPLETED ALL-INDIA CENSUS IS THE BASELINE FOR · SURVEY RULE · A NEWER FIGURE MUST CARRY A NAMED SURVEY AND · DENSITY, GROWTH, LITERACY, SEX RATIO, SPEAKER AND SHARE FIGURES · 9 JULY 2024 · MINISTRY OF TRIBAL AFFAIRS STATE-WISE LIST OF VULNERABLE TRIBAL

CENSUS RULE → the last completed all-India Census is the baseline for any figure → **SURVEY RULE → a newer figure must carry a named survey and its date** → **FORBIDDEN → density, growth, literacy, sex ratio, speaker and share figures from memory** → **9 JULY 2024 → Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list of vulnerable tribal groups** → **READING → identity and habitat remain geographically organised for present policy**

CORE CLAIM

- CENSUS RULE → the last completed all-India Census is the baseline for any figure
- SURVEY RULE → a newer figure must carry a named survey and its date

MECHANISM

- FORBIDDEN → density, growth, literacy, sex ratio, speaker and share figures from memory
- 9 JULY 2024 → Ministry of Tribal Affairs state-wise list of vulnerable tribal groups

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- READING → identity and habitat remain geographically organised for present policy
- CENSUS RULE → the last completed all-India Census is the baseline for any figure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SURVEY RULE → a newer figure must carry a named survey and its date.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ARTICLE 350B CREATES THE OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER FOR · THIS IS WHERE CULTURAL GEOGRAPHY MEETS CONSTITUTIONAL GEOGRAPHY · LANGUAGE IS NOT · ONLY A SOCIAL FACT BUT ALSO AN ADMINISTRATIVE AND · LINGUISTIC STATES REDUCED SOME TENSIONS AFTER REORGANISATION, BUT DID · NOT ERASE MINORITY POCKETS, BORDER DIALECTS OR METROPOLITAN MULTILINGUALISM · CENSUS 2011 IS STILL THE CORRECT ALL-INDIA BENCHMARK FOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Article 350B creates the office of the Commissioner for Linguistic Minorities .
- CAUTION: This is where cultural geography meets constitutional geography: language is not
- only a social fact but also an administrative and rights-based category.
- CAUTION: Linguistic states reduced some tensions after reorganisation, but did

ADVANCED DEBATE

- not erase minority pockets, border dialects or metropolitan multilingualism.
- Census 2011 is still the correct all-India benchmark for language and religion
- data in UPSC answers unless a newer official release is specifically available.
- India has 22 scheduled languages in the Eighth Schedule.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Linguistic families and scheduled languages are different classification levels.
- Scheduled Areas (Fifth Schedule) and Sixth Schedule areas are not the same constitutional mechanism.
- PVTG count = 75, across 18 states and 1 UT, as per Ministry of Tribal Affairs' July 2024 list.
- NOT: Scheduled language = majority language in every district of its state - linguistic geography always has transition zones and minority belts.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels